

From Aspiration To Authorship

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Manish Gupta and Dell has seen every era this anniversary is celebrating, from the dial-up dream to the AI sovereignty pitch. His view of the next 25 years is the most India-confident in the package: a nation moving from absorbing technology to authoring it, with AI infrastructure as the new strategic high ground.

Tech evolution in past 25 years?

Cast your mind back to 2000. A personal computer was an aspiration for most Indian households. Broadband was a distant dream. Mobile, a luxury. And yet, a young, hungry nation was beginning to sense the scale of what was possible. What followed was extraordinary; India didn't just adopt tech, it absorbed it, adapted it, began building it for the world.

From personal computing to smartphones, from cloud to AI, each wave brought new possibilities and new challenges. Technology stopped being just functional, it became cultural. Products like Alienware did not just define hardware it defined an identity for a generation. Audience grew more informed, demanding, and ambitious.

Industries transformed. Startups emerged. A technology culture was forged.

Digit and Dell were both part of that story. One giving technology a voice, the other helping build the

infrastructure behind it. India went from aspiration to authorship, and this shared milestone reflects that incredible journey.

How is tech going to transform our lives in the next 25 years?

India now has the largest workforce of AI engineers in the world. This year, enterprises will make a decisive shift by moving AI from experimentation into large-scale production. We are also seeing the rise of edge computing, where inferencing happens right where data is created, alongside a complete reinvention of data centers around energy efficiency and sustainability. Ultimately, we are entering a world of autonomous multi-agent environments and expert systems delivering real value globally.

AI sovereignty will define the next decade. Nations that own their AI

infrastructure will have a structural advantage, and 'Make in India' is at the heart of that story. Our AI India Blueprint, unveiled at the India AI Impact Summit 2026, is designed to deliver exactly that, moving the ecosystem from isolated pilots to population-scale deployment, embedding AI as a core pillar of Digital Public Infrastructure and a shared national capability under the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.

Any message to Digit on completing 25 years?

Twenty-five years is a remarkable milestone, and I say that as someone who has been on a parallel journey.

Digit showed up at exactly the right moment, with honest product reviews, trusted buying guides, and that iconic monthly CD and DVD bundled with every issue, which was nothing short of a lifeline in pre-broadband India. It built a loyal community of enthusiasts, students, and professionals who refused to take specifications at face value and stayed relevant across every major technology shift. Very few media brands survive multiple technology eras and multiple generations of readers. That takes editorial conviction and a genuine love for tech.

Here is to the next 25 years, of continuing to be the voice India's tech community trusts. We at Dell are proud to have grown alongside you. 



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